

A CYBER-AWARENESS CARD GAME

HUMAN FIREWALL

Everyday cyber risks, real decisions, no jargon. A discussion-driven game for the whole team.

24 Scenario Cards · 7 Role Cards · 14 Event Cards · 5 Decision Cards · Score Tracker · Facilitator Guide

Built for HR · Finance · Sales · Execs · Admin · New Hires · Remote Workers

What this game is

Human Firewall turns cyber-security awareness into a 30–45 minute table conversation. A scenario lands — a suspicious email, an urgent call, a found USB stick — and the team decides how to react. The facilitator reveals what happens, the score moves, and everyone learns through consequences instead of slides.

The one rule that teaches everything: when something is urgent, unexpected and asks for money, data or access — slow down and verify it through a channel you already trust.

Who it's for

Designed for non-technical staff: HR, finance, sales, executives, administrative teams, brand-new hires and remote workers. No security background is needed to play or to facilitate.

What players practise

- **Spotting** everyday attacks: phishing, fake invoices, QR scams, MFA fatigue, deepfake calls, smishing and more.
- **Deciding** calmly under pressure using five simple choices.
- **Habits** that scale: verify out of band, report early, never share codes, badge everyone in.
- **Communication**: who to check with, and how to raise a concern without fear.

Components & setup

In the kit

- **24 Scenario cards** — the heart of the game (the deck is designed to scale to 50+).
- **7 Role cards** — each player takes a workplace role with its own attack profile and one special ability.
- **14 Event cards** — pressure and reward twists the facilitator can drop in.
- **5 Decision cards** — TRUST, VERIFY, REPORT, IGNORE, ESCALATE (print one set per player).
- **Score Tracker** — four team meters plus a 10-incident log.
- **Outcomes Key** — facilitator-only answers for every scenario (keep this hidden from players).

Setup (about 5 minutes)

- 1 Pick a facilitator.** They run the round, keep the Outcomes Key, and move the score. They don't 'win' — they coach.
- 2 Deal a role** to each player (2–6 players is ideal; larger groups split into teams).
- 3 Give every player a set of Decision cards** so they can show their choice.
- 4 Set the meters** on the Score Tracker to their starting values, and shuffle the Scenario and Event decks separately.

How a round works

- 1 Draw a Scenario.** The facilitator reads it aloud. It usually targets a specific role — that player leads, but everyone joins in.
- 2 Discuss (1–2 min).** Is it real? How would you check? Who should approve? This conversation is where the learning happens.
- 3 Decide.** The lead player (or the team) plays one Decision card face-up.
- 4 Reveal the consequence.** The facilitator reads the matching outcome from the Outcomes Key and adjusts the meters.
- 5 Share the learning point** from the key, then move to the next incident. Drop in an Event card whenever you want to raise the pressure.

The four meters

All four are tracked for the whole team — you win or lose together.

Reputation 70
Public & customer trust. 0 = ruined.

Funds 100k
Company money. 0 = bankrupt.

Security Score 60
How hardened you are. 0 = wide open.

Stress 30
Team pressure — **lower is better**. 100 = burnout.

Win (Cooperative): survive 10 incidents with Reputation ≥ 50 , Funds > 0 , Security ≥ 40 and Stress ≤ 80 .

Instant loss if any meter hits its danger point: Funds 0 (bankrupt), Reputation 0 (ruined), Security 0 (fully breached) or Stress 100 (the team burns out).

Final rating: 80–100 Security = “Human Firewall ★★★” · 60–79 = “Security-Aware ★★” · 40–59 = “Getting There ★”.

Three ways to play

Cooperative Mode (default — best for workshops)

Everyone protects the company together against the deck. Discuss openly and aim for the best collective call on each incident.

Hidden Attacker Mode (teaches insider risk)

Before the game, secretly deal one player an “Insider” marker. They play along but quietly steer the group toward bad choices during discussion. If the team finishes still meeting the win conditions, the defenders win; if two or more meters crash, the insider wins. Afterwards, debrief: *what nudges did we miss?*

Speed Round (great for energy)

Teams have 60 seconds per scenario to discuss and commit a Decision — no outcome is revealed until the timer ends. Rewards instinct and exposes the gut-reaction “just click it” habit.

Facilitator tips

- **Let the wrong answer happen.** A bad outcome with a calm debrief teaches more than steering players to the ‘right’ card.
- **Ask “how would you verify?”** every round until it becomes a reflex.
- **Make reporting safe.** Reward REPORT generously and never mock a near-miss — in real life, fear of blame is what hides breaches.
- **Tie it back to your tools.** Name your real report-phishing button, your IT number and your payment-approval process during the debrief.
- **Keep it to ~45 minutes.** Ten incidents plus a short debrief is plenty for one sitting.

Adapting to your industry

Swap a few scenario themes to make it hit home. Same mechanics, familiar context:

Sector	Tailor scenarios toward...
Hospitals & Clinics	Fake patient-record requests, ‘doctor’ calls for urgent prescriptions, vendor invoice fraud.
Banks & Finance	Wire-transfer fraud, fake regulator emails, ‘account verification’ phishing.
Schools & Universities	Parent/teacher phishing, fake fee-payment links, student-data requests.
Retail	POS malware, fake supplier invoices, gift-card scams, QR menu/payment scams.
Shipping & Logistics	Fake customs emails, courier SMS scams, redirected-payment invoice fraud.

Law & Professional Services	Client-impersonation, confidential-document requests, deepfake partner calls.
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Later expansions can add a mobile app, Microsoft Teams integration, AI-generated practice phishing, and company-customised scenario packs.

Outcomes Key — Facilitator only, keep hidden

For each scenario, read the outcome that matches the Decision the team played, apply the meter changes, then share the learning point. Funds changes are shown in 'k' (thousands).

PHISHING

Scenario #01

The Password Reset

TRUST	You enter your password on the fake page. Credentials stolen — the attacker logs in. Sec -20Rep -10Stress +15
VERIFY	You hover the link, see a strange domain, and open the real portal yourself. No harm done. Sec +5
REPORT	You use 'Report Phishing'. Security blocks the sender for the whole company. Sec +10Stress -5
IGNORE	You delete it. You're safe, but colleagues still receive the same trap. no change
ESCALATE	Your manager confirms it's fake. Minor delay, no harm. Sec +5Stress +5

Best move:

REPORT (or VERIFY)

Learning point:

Real providers never ask you to confirm a password through an email link — go to the site yourself, or report it.

PASSWORDS

Scenario #02

The Reuse Trap

TRUST	You assume it's fine and change nothing. Attackers reuse the password and break into your email. Sec -20Funds -10kStress +15
VERIFY	You confirm the alert is really from IT, then realise the risk. Good caution. Sec +5
REPORT	You tell security, who force a reset before anyone gets in. Sec +10Stress -5
IGNORE	You move on. The reused password is quietly abused weeks later. Sec -10Stress +10
ESCALATE	You ask IT to reset everywhere and switch on MFA and a password manager. Sec +15Funds -5kStress -5

Best move:

ESCALATE / REPORT

Learning point:

One leaked password unlocks everything if you reuse it — use unique passwords and a password manager.

Approve? Approve? Approve?

TRUST You tap Approve just to make it stop. The attacker is now inside your account.

Sec -20 Rep -5 Stress +15

VERIFY You check the location and time, see it isn't you, and deny it.

Sec +5

REPORT You deny it and alert security. They lock the account and block the attacker.

Sec +15 Stress -5

IGNORE You deny and silence your phone. The attack stops, but no one is warned.

Sec +5 Stress +5

ESCALATE You call IT, who reset your credentials immediately.

Sec +10

Best move: REPORT

Learning point: Never approve a login prompt you didn't start — repeated prompts are an attack. Deny and report.

Scan to Pay

TRUST You scan and enter your card. The details are stolen on a fake page.

Sec -10 Funds -15k Stress +10

VERIFY You use the meter's official app instead of the sticker. Safe.

Sec +5

REPORT You tell facilities/security. The fake sticker is removed and others are protected.

Sec +10 Stress -5

IGNORE You ignore it and pay another way. No harm to you.

no change

ESCALATE Facilities investigate where the sticker came from.

Sec +5

Best move: REPORT

Learning point: A QR code hides where it really goes — don't scan random ones in public; use the official app or site.

The Bank Details Changed

TRUST	You pay the new account. The money goes straight to a fraudster. Rep -10 Funds -25k Stress +15
VERIFY	You call the supplier on the number you already have. The change is fake. Sec +5
REPORT	You flag it to security and finance. The fraud is caught and others are warned. Sec +10 Stress -5
IGNORE	You don't pay at all. Awkward with a real supplier, but no money lost. Rep -5 Stress +5
ESCALATE	Dual approval catches the mismatch before payment. Stress +5

Best move: VERIFY (call a known number)

Learning point: Always confirm changed bank details by calling a number you already trust — never the one on the invoice.

Free Airport Wi-Fi

TRUST	You join the open network and send it. Your traffic is snooped on a rogue hotspot. Sec -15 Rep -5 Stress +10
VERIFY	You confirm the official network and use the company VPN. Safe send. Sec +5
REPORT	Little to report here, but you note the suspicious twin network. no change
IGNORE	You wait and use your phone's data instead. Safe, slight delay. Stress +5
ESCALATE	You ask IT to confirm VPN access first. Sec +5 Stress +5

Best move: VERIFY (VPN or your own hotspot)

Learning point: Open Wi-Fi can be faked and snooped — use a VPN or your own mobile hotspot for anything sensitive.

The Found Drive

TRUST You plug it in. Malware runs automatically and spreads onto the network.

Sec -20

Funds -10k

Stress +15

VERIFY There's no safe way to 'check' it by plugging in — you treat it as suspicious.

Sec +5

REPORT You hand it to IT, who examine it safely in isolation.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE You bin it. Safe, but a possible drop attack goes unreported.

no change

ESCALATE IT investigate a possible 'USB drop' targeting the office.

Sec +10

Best move: REPORT

Learning point: 'USB drop' attacks bait your curiosity — never plug in a drive you found. Hand it to IT.

The CEO's Voice

TRUST You make the transfer. The voice was AI-cloned; the funds are gone.

Rep -10

Funds -25k

Stress +20

VERIFY You call the CEO back on a known number (or use your code word). It's fake.

Sec +5

REPORT You flag the attempt to security. The team is warned about voice-clone fraud.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE You hang up. Safe, but the attempt isn't reported.

Stress +5

ESCALATE You require the normal payment-approval process, which stops it.

Stress +5

Best move: VERIFY (call back on a trusted number)

Learning point: AI can clone a voice. Urgency + secrecy + money is the scam pattern — always verify on a known channel.

The Helpful Post

TRUST The post stays up. Attackers harvest the details for a targeted phishing attack.

Sec -10 Rep -5 Stress +5

VERIFY You check exactly what's visible in the photo first.

Sec +5

REPORT You quietly flag it; the post is taken down and friendly guidance is given.

Sec +10 Stress -5

IGNORE The post stays public and the risk remains.

Sec -5

ESCALATE You ask a manager to clarify the social-media policy for everyone.

Sec +5

Best move: REPORT (and coach them)

Learning point: Badges, screens and 'behind the scenes' posts leak details attackers use. Think before you post.

Your Files Are Locked

TRUST You pay the ransom. There's no guarantee of recovery — and you're now a known payer.

Sec -10 Funds -25k Stress +20

VERIFY You don't negotiate alone — you get help before doing anything.

no change

REPORT You disconnect the device and call IT at once. The spread is contained; backups restore the files.

Sec +10 Stress -5

IGNORE You keep working. The ransomware spreads to shared drives.

Sec -20 Stress +15

ESCALATE Incident response and leadership coordinate a clean recovery — no payment.

Sec +15 Funds -5k

Best move: REPORT (disconnect & call IT)

Learning point: Don't pay and don't panic — isolate the device and call IT. Good backups beat ransoms.

WhatsApp from the CFO

TRUST You make the payment. It goes to a fraudster impersonating the CFO.

Rep -10

Funds -20k

Stress +15

VERIFY You call the CFO on their known number. They never sent it.

Sec +5

REPORT You report the message; the team is warned and the number is blocked.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE You don't act on it. Safe.

Stress +5

ESCALATE The standard approval process stops the rushed payment.

Stress +5

Best move: VERIFY (out of band)

Learning point: Executives don't run urgent payments via WhatsApp from new numbers — verify on a channel you trust.

Send Me Payroll

TRUST You send the file. The account was hijacked — employee data is leaked.

Sec -15

Rep -15

Stress +15

VERIFY You reach your manager another way and learn their account was compromised.

Sec +10

REPORT You flag the account to IT, who secure it before more damage is done.

Sec +15

Stress -5

IGNORE You don't send it, but the hijacked account stays active and dangerous.

Sec -5

ESCALATE Manager and security are looped in and the account is locked.

Sec +10

Best move: VERIFY, then REPORT

Learning point: Even a trusted account can be hijacked — verify unusual data requests through another channel.

Your Parcel Is Waiting

TRUST You pay the 'fee.' Your card and details are stolen, with recurring charges.

Sec -10

Funds -10k

Stress +10

VERIFY You check the courier's official app — there's no such fee.

Sec +5

REPORT You report the SMS; the link is blocked for others too.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE You delete it. Safe.

no change

ESCALATE Not much to escalate — but you warn a colleague.

Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY / REPORT

Learning point: Couriers don't collect 'fees' via random SMS links — check the official tracking app instead.

The Fake Executive

TRUST You reply and help, and get drawn into a gift-card / transfer scam.

Rep -5

Funds -10k

Stress +10

VERIFY You confirm with the CEO's real contact — the account is fake.

Sec +5

REPORT You report the impersonation; the account is taken down and staff are warned.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE You ignore it. Safe for you; others may still be targeted.

no change

ESCALATE Comms and security alert all staff to the fake account.

Sec +10

Best move: REPORT

Learning point: Impersonation accounts copy names and photos — verify identity before acting on 'confidential' asks.

IT Support Calling

TRUST You install the 'fix' and grant access. The caller now controls your PC.

Sec -20

Stress +15

VERIFY You hang up and call IT on the number you know. There's no such ticket.

Sec +5

REPORT You report the call so security can warn others.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE You hang up and move on. Safe.

Stress +5

ESCALATE IT investigate the spoofed support call.

Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY (call IT back yourself)

Learning point: Real IT won't cold-call you for remote access — hang up and call the number you already know.

A Quick Favour

TRUST You buy the cards and send the codes. The money is gone and unrecoverable.

Funds -15k

Stress +10

VERIFY You call the boss directly. They never asked for this.

Sec +5

REPORT You report it; colleagues are warned about the same scam.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE You don't act. Safe.

Stress +5

ESCALATE A manager confirms it's a scam.

Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY / REPORT

Learning point: 'Buy gift cards and send the codes' is almost always a scam — verify any unusual money request.

Hold the Door

TRUST You hold the door. An unauthorised stranger is now inside the building.

Sec -15

Stress +10

VERIFY You politely point them to reception to sign in. They had no business there.

Sec +10

REPORT You alert security, who check and escort them.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE You let the door close behind you. Safe-ish, but no one is alerted.

no change

ESCALATE Reception verifies whether they have an appointment.

Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY (send them to reception)

Learning point: 'Tailgating' bypasses all your tech security — everyone badges in, no exceptions, however polite.

There's an App for That

TRUST You upload the data. The client list is now in the hands of an unknown third party.

Sec -10

Rep -10

Stress +5

VERIFY You check with IT whether the tool is approved — it isn't, so you find a safe option.

Sec +5

REPORT You ask IT to vet it; they approve a safe alternative.

Sec +10

IGNORE You stick with the approved process. No harm done.

no change

ESCALATE IT review and provide a sanctioned tool.

Sec +10

Best move: VERIFY / ESCALATE with IT

Learning point: Free 'helpful' tools can harvest your data — check with IT before uploading any company information.

Enable Content to View

TRUST You enable content. Hidden macro malware runs on your machine.

Sec -20

Stress +15

VERIFY You weren't expecting it, so you don't enable anything and check the sender.

Sec +5

REPORT You report it as phishing; the sender is blocked.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE You close the file. Safe.

no change

ESCALATE IT examine the file in a safe environment.

Sec +5

Best move: REPORT (don't enable content)

Learning point: 'Enable content' on an unexpected document can run hidden malware — when in doubt, report it.

Left on the Train

TRUST You wait and hope it turns up. The data is exposed if the wrong person finds it.

Sec -10

Rep -10

Stress +15

VERIFY You retrace your steps and check lost property — but every minute counts.

Stress +5

REPORT You tell IT immediately; they remote-lock and wipe it before anyone can access it.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE You say nothing. The unsecured laptop becomes a breach.

Sec -15

Rep -15

Stress +15

ESCALATE IT and your manager handle containment and any disclosure.

Sec +10

Best move: REPORT (fast, so IT can wipe it)

Learning point: Report lost devices immediately — a quick remote lock or wipe turns a disaster into a non-event.

Too Much Information

TRUST The detailed reply stays on — it hands attackers a ready-made map for a payment scam.

Sec -10

Stress +5

VERIFY You trim it to the bare minimum before turning it on.

Sec +5

REPORT You suggest a company-wide auto-reply guideline.

Sec +5

IGNORE The over-sharing reply stays live and the risk remains.

Sec -5

ESCALATE A manager updates the team's out-of-office standard.

Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY (keep it minimal)

Learning point: Out-of-office replies can reveal names, dates and who approves money — keep them vague.

From the New Auditor

TRUST You send the list. It's used to build a convincing mass-phishing campaign.

Sec -15

Rep -5

Stress +10

VERIFY You confirm with your own finance/audit contact — there is no such auditor.

Sec +10

REPORT You report the call; staff are warned of the pretext.

Sec +10

Stress -5

IGNORE You don't send anything. Safe.

no change

ESCALATE A manager verifies whether any audit is actually engaged.

Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY (through your own contact)

Learning point: 'Officials' who pressure you for staff data are a classic pretext — verify through a contact you already trust.

Read Me Your Code

TRUST You read the code aloud. That code was the key — the attacker completes their login.

Sec -15 Funds -20k Stress +15

VERIFY You hang up and call the bank on the number on your card. It's a scam.

Sec +10

REPORT You report the call and freeze the account.

Sec +5 Stress -5

IGNORE You hang up. Safe.

Stress +5

ESCALATE You loop in your bank's verified fraud line.

Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY (never share a code)

Learning point: No real bank or service ever asks you to read back a one-time code — that code unlocks your account.

Day-One Request

TRUST They fill in the form. Their identity and bank details are phished.

Rep -5 Funds -10k Stress +10

VERIFY They ask HR how payroll is really set up — through the official system, not a form.

Sec +10

REPORT They flag it; the fake onboarding email is blocked.

Sec +10 Stress -5

IGNORE Payroll setup stalls briefly, but no harm done.

Stress +5

ESCALATE HR confirms the correct, secure process.

Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY (with HR directly)

Learning point: New hires are prime targets — confirm any 'onboarding' data request with HR directly, never via a random form.

Scenario Cards (1 of the deck)

Print, then cut along the borders. Colour bands show the attack channel. Players see only the front — outcomes live in the Outcomes Key.

PHISHING#01 The Password Reset TARGETS: ANYONE An urgent email “from Microsoft” warns your account will be locked in 24 hours. It tells you to click a link and re-enter your password now. What do you do? Choose a Decision card.	PASSWORDS#02 The Reuse Trap TARGETS: ANYONE IT warns that a website where you used your work password has been breached. The same password also protects your work email. What do you do? Choose a Decision card.	MFA FATIGUE#03 Approve? Approve? Approve? TARGETS: ANYONE Your phone buzzes with login-approval requests over and over at 11pm — sign-ins you never started. One more pops up. What do you do? Choose a Decision card.
QR SCAM#04 Scan to Pay TARGETS: ANYONE A sticker on the office parking meter reads “Scan to pay / update card details.” The QR code opens a payment page. What do you do? Choose a Decision card.	INVOICE FRAUD#05 The Bank Details Changed TARGETS: FINANCE OFFICER A known supplier emails a normal-looking invoice, with a note: “Please note our bank account has changed — pay the new account below.” What do you do? Choose a Decision card.	PUBLIC WI-FI#06 Free Airport Wi-Fi TARGETS: SALESPERSON At the airport you see “Airport_Free_WiFi” and “FREE Airport WiFi!!!”. You need to send a client contract now. What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

USB DROP

#07

The Found Drive

TARGETS: ANYONE

You find a USB stick in the car park labelled "Payroll 2025 — Confidential." Curiosity says plug it in.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEEPPFAKE CALL

#08

The CEO's Voice

TARGETS: FINANCE OFFICER / ADMIN

A call comes in. It sounds exactly like the CEO: "I'm in a meeting — move €40,000 to this account right now, and keep it quiet."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

OVERSHARING

#09

The Helpful Post

TARGETS: INTERN / NEW HIRE

An intern proudly posts a first-day photo — their screen, their badge, and "Can't believe how easy our new vendor portal login is!"

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

RANSOMWARE

#10

Your Files Are Locked

TARGETS: ANYONE

A red full-screen message appears: "All your files are encrypted. Pay \$2,000 in crypto within 48 hours or lose everything." A colleague says "just pay it!"

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

BEC

#11

WhatsApp from the CFO

TARGETS: FINANCE OFFICER / ADMIN

A WhatsApp from a new number shows your CFO's photo: "Hi, stuck in a meeting — can you sort an urgent supplier payment? I'll explain later."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

COMPROMISED ACCOUNT

#12

Send Me Payroll

TARGETS: HR MANAGER / FINANCE

A Microsoft Teams message from your manager's account: "Hey, can you send me the payroll spreadsheet urgently? I'm boarding a flight."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

SMISHING

#13

Your Parcel Is Waiting

TARGETS: ANYONE

SMS: "Your delivery failed. Pay a €1.99 redelivery fee here: [link]." You happen to be expecting a parcel.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

IMPERSONATION

#14

The Fake Executive

TARGETS: ANYONE

A brand-new account using the CEO's name and photo messages staff: "I need your mobile number for a quick confidential task."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

VISHING

#15

IT Support Calling

TARGETS: ANYONE

A caller says: "This is IT — we've found a virus on your PC. I'll walk you through installing a fix; just grant me remote access."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

GIFT-CARD SCAM

#16

A Quick Favour

TARGETS: ADMIN / INTERN

Email from "the boss": "At your desk? I need €500 in gift cards for client gifts — send me the codes. In meetings, can't talk."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

TAILGATING

#17

Hold the Door

TARGETS: RECEPTIONIST / ANYONE

Someone in a delivery uniform, arms full of boxes, smiles at the secure door behind you: "Thanks — could you hold it? I've forgotten my badge."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

SHADOW IT

#18

There's an App for That

TARGETS: SALESPERSON / ANYONE

To work faster, a teammate suggests uploading the full client list to a free online tool they found to 'clean it up.'

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

MALWARE DOC

#19

Enable Content to View

TARGETS: ANYONE

An attachment, "Invoice.docx," opens to a banner: "Protected view — Enable Content to see this document."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

LOST DEVICE

#20

Left on the Train

TARGETS: SALESPERSON

You realise your work laptop — logged in and full of client data — was left on the train.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

OVERSHARING

#21

Too Much Information

TARGETS: ADMIN / EXECUTIVE

An auto-reply reads: "On holiday in Bali until the 20th. For payments contact Maria; for the CEO's diary, Tom (+number)."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

PRETEXTING

#22

From the New Auditor

TARGETS: HR MANAGER / FINANCE

A polite caller claims to be a new external auditor and asks you to email a list of all staff names, emails and job titles 'for the audit.'

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

CODE THEFT

#23

Read Me Your Code

TARGETS: ANYONE

Right after a login alert, you get a call: "Hi, your bank's fraud team here. To cancel the suspicious login, read me the 6-digit code we just texted you."

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

ONBOARDING SCAM

#24

Day-One Request

TARGETS: INTERN / NEW HIRE / HR

It's a new hire's first morning. An email from 'Facilities' asks them to confirm their home address, ID number and bank details via a web form 'to set up payroll.'

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

Role Cards

Deal one per player. Each role has its own attack profile and a once-per-game special ability.

ROLE

Receptionist / Front Desk

The first point of contact for every visitor, call and delivery.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Tailgating, suspicious visitors, phone scams.

Special: Gatekeeper — once per game, auto-resolve any physical/visitor scenario as VERIFY (prevented).

ROLE

HR Manager

Holds the personal data of everyone in the company.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Fake onboarding, data requests, payroll phishing.

Special: Records Lock — once per game, cancel one Reputation loss from a data-leak outcome.

ROLE

Finance Officer

Controls payments — the prize attackers want most.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Invoice fraud, business-email compromise, deepfake transfer calls.

Special: Dual Control — once per game, force VERIFY on a money scenario (no Funds lost that round).

ROLE

CEO / Executive

High authority and a public profile — often the person attackers impersonate.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Impersonation and deepfakes (as the faked person), targeted phishing.

Special: Set the Tone — once per game, reduce the team's Stress by 10.

ROLE

Intern / New Hire

Eager to help and still learning what's normal.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Pressure tactics, onboarding scams, oversharing online.

Special: Beginner's Question — once per game, ask the facilitator one yes/no question before deciding.

ROLE

IT / Developer

Keeps the systems running and is trusted with access.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Vishing ('IT support'), malicious files, shadow IT.

Special: Patch It — once per game, turn one REPORT into a guaranteed 'attack prevented.'

ROLE

Salesperson

Always on the move, with lots of external contact and devices.

OFTEN TARGETED BY

Public Wi-Fi, lost devices, QR scams.

Special: Road Warrior — once per game, ignore one Stress penalty.

Event Cards

The facilitator drops these in to add pressure (or the occasional reward).

EVENT IT Is Overloaded Any REPORT this round takes effect next round instead of now.	EVENT The CEO Is on Vacation You can't verify with the CEO this round: +5 Stress on any CEO-related scenario.	EVENT Journalist Calls If Reputation is below 60, lose 5 more Reputation. Otherwise, no effect.
EVENT Customer Complains Online Reputation -5 immediately.	EVENT Payday Rush Finance is slammed — the next money scenario adds +5 Stress.	EVENT Audit Week Good security calls this round earn +5 extra Security Score.
EVENT System Outage Everyone's Stress +10.	EVENT Budget Cuts Funds -10.	EVENT Awareness Training Done Reward: Security +10 and Stress -5.
EVENT Holiday Scam Surge Draw and resolve TWO scenario cards this round.	EVENT Phishing Simulation Your own security team sends a test. Resolve the next scenario with no Funds penalty.	EVENT New-Starter Week Every scenario this round targets the Intern / New Hire if possible.

EVENT

Backups Verified

Reward: the next REPORT on a ransomware/malware scenario fully prevents it.

EVENT

VIP Visit

Reputation is fragile — any TRUST mistake this round costs +5 extra Reputation.

Decision Cards

Print one set per player. These are the only five choices anyone ever needs.

DECISION

TRUST

Do exactly what the message or caller asks. Comply with the request.

DECISION

VERIFY

Independently confirm through a second, trusted channel before acting.

DECISION

REPORT

Flag it to IT / Security (report-phishing button, ticket, or security@).

DECISION

IGNORE

Do nothing. Delete or dismiss it and move on.

DECISION

ESCALATE

Hand the decision to a manager or security lead for approval.

Score Tracker

Mark each meter's starting box, then move it as outcomes are revealed. The team survives by keeping all four in safe territory across 10 incidents.

Reputation

Public & customer trust. Lose at 0. Win-line: keep ≥ 50 .

Start at 70

05101520253035404550556065707580859095100

Funds (in thousands)

Company money. Bankrupt at 0. Win-line: keep > 0 .

Start at 100

05101520253035404550556065707580859095100

Security Score

How hardened you are. Fully breached at 0. Win-line: keep ≥ 40 .

Start at 60

05101520253035404550556065707580859095100

Stress (lower is better)

Team pressure. Burnout at 100. Win-line: keep ≤ 80 .

Start at 30

05101520253035404550556065707580859095100

Incident log

#	Scenario	Decision played	Outcome / meter changes
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			